



Student Government Association

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First Reading 03-29-94
Second Reading _____
Pass _____
Fail _____
Other _____

RESOLUTION 94-5-S

REQUEST FOR FUNDING FOR SOCIAL WORK FACULTY MEMBER

INTRODUCED: March 29, 1994

Purpose: For the Potter College of Arts, Humanities, and Social Sciences to allocate the existing funds to the Social Work program.

Whereas: The current budget proposal suggests that the field coordinator position for the Social Work Program be eliminated, and,

Whereas: The social work program is barely surviving as it is, and with the deletion of an additional faculty member the program will begin to diminish, and

Whereas: The current student/faculty ratio is 40:1 and with the elimination of this faculty position it will continue to rise, and

Whereas: Accreditation by the Council on Social Work Education mandates that the student/faculty ratio be at 25:1, and

Whereas: The Social Work program is already operating above maximum capacity in order to receive its next accreditation, and

Whereas: Many students are remaining in school extra semesters because there are not enough faculty members to offer all of the courses needed to graduate on schedule, and

Whereas: Western Kentucky University should have a main priority to offer the courses needed and educate the currently

enrolled students without an undue financial burden on the students, and

Whereas: The focus of WKU should be to provide a sufficient staff in order to educate the students, and

Whereas: The Potter College of Arts, Humanities, and Social Sciences has money available to offer to one department under its jurisdiction for the purpose of hiring a faculty member, and

Whereas: If the Social Work program does not receive an additional faculty member it will begin to decline, and

Whereas: Two-hundred five (205) students in the Social Work program strongly support funding and maintaining the program at its current level, and

Whereas: Support from the Student Government Association would enhance our cause and show a genuine interest from the students in providing a quality education and each academic program at Western.

Therefore: Be it resolved that we, the members of the Student Government Association, recommend that the Potter College of Arts, Humanities, and Social Sciences allocate the existing funds to hire a faculty member in the Social Work program.

Author: Heather Meenach
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Sponsor: Academic Affairs